Thamesmead Times

Issue No. 1 December 1987

Thamesmead Town

A new voice for our Town

THIS first edition of Thamesmead Times – a newspaper for, by and about the people of Thamesmead Town – could also be the last.

It has been produced at the request of the Town's democratically elected Board of Directors in order to see what you –the people they represent – think about it.

Those of us who have been involved in the production of this first issue very much hope to be repeating the performance every month for many years to come. But ultimately the decision rests with you.

On Page 7 there is a Form which we hope you will fill in to tell us what you think of the paper. Some of you will already be involved by having provided information for stories or features that appear in this issue.

And of course it is our intention that as many people and organisations as possible in Thamesmead will come to regard this as their paper. As well as giving you information and news about what Thamesmead Town is planning on your behalf, it will give you an opportunity to "get in on the act" by expressing your views at a stage when you can still influence what is going on.

We want you to take that opportunity and give us the chance to continue to serve you.

Thamesmead Times is published by Thamesmead Town

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Registration applied for

PAY UP OR ELSE THREAT

TENANTS COME FIRST, SAYS TOWN CHIEF

GREENWICH COUNCIL have threatened to force Thamesmead tenants to travel to Woolwich to have their Housing Benefit claims dealt with unless Thamesmead Town pays more than £50,000 to purchase and commission a new Housing Benefits system so that their agency can be extended for another year.

This is despite the Company examining ways of assisting Greenwich in a decentralised office in Harrow Manor Way.

Reacting swiftly to the ultimatum, Thamesmead Town Chief Executive Philip Glascoe is recommending to the Board of Directors that they foot the bill rather than cause distress and inconvenience to tenants.

The Council, who shocked residents at a meeting of the Thamesmead Advisory Forum recently, by suggesting it was immoral and a risk to tenants' confidentiality for Thamesmead Town to continue handling Housing Benefits because they were "private landlords", delivered their ultimatum last week.

Depressing

Talks had been going on for some time about the Council's decision to end an agency agreement under which Thamesmead Town had administered Housing Benefits since 1986.

Bexley Council have said they are more than happy to allow Thamesmead Town to continue to do the job for them.

Thamesmead Chief Executive Philip Glascoe described Greenwich's move as "depressing in view of their stated wish during all our discussions not to cause any disruption of the service or inconvenience to tenants."

He added: "It now seems clear that, for all their high moral viewpoint, when it comes to a question of cash, they are prepared to put the tenants at risk in order to get their own way."

He said he was recommending strongly to the Board of Thamesmead Town that they should foot the bill to enable the agency to be extended.

Morally wrong

"I cannot imagine our Directors will be willing to cause such trouble to our tenants as would result from the service being run from Woolwich for a year," he declared.

That would be the situation if Thamesmead refused to foot the bill.

Only days after claiming it was morally wrong for private landlords to deal with Housing Benefit, Greenwich Council is prepared to extend Thamesmead Town's agency agreement for a further year if they agree to pay the costs.

This will mean tenants will continue to receive the high standard of service that they have enjoyed since 1986.

Clive Thornton, Chairman
and Directors of Thamesmead Town
send
Seasonal Greetings
to all Thamesmead
residents

Cung Chúc Tân Xuân

恭賀新禧

Thamesmead Town

CAB NEEDS HELPING HANDS

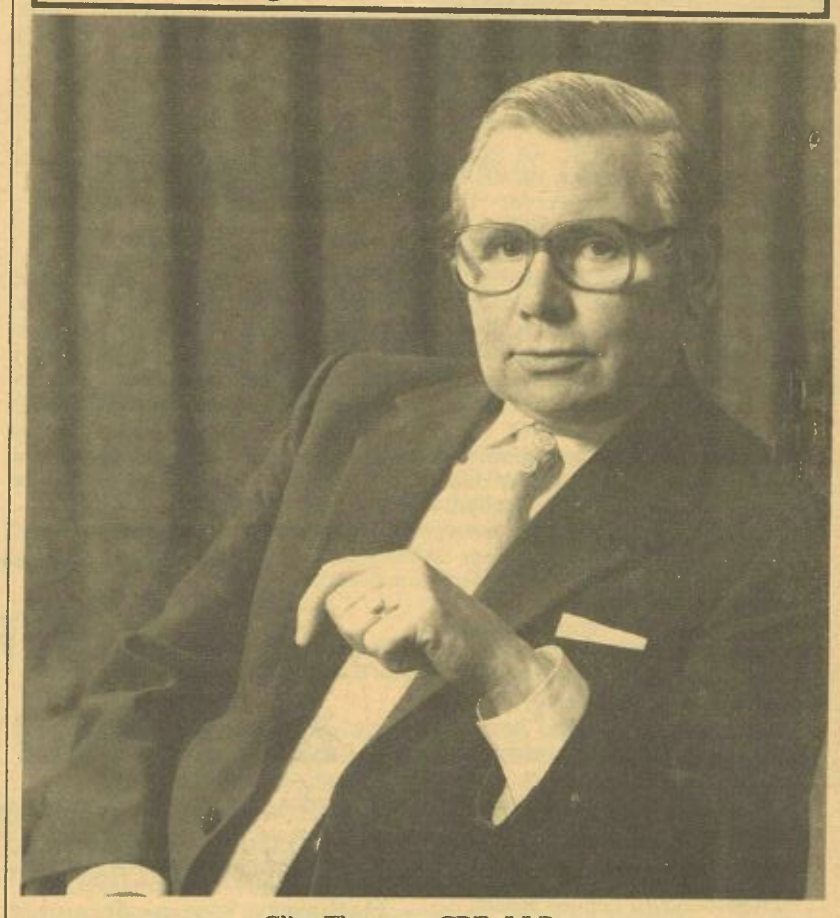
VOLUNTEERS are urgently needed to help maintain the excellent service provided by Thamesmead Citizens' Advice Bureau at Binsey Walk.

Bureau Manager Colin Smith is worried because staff shortages have meant the office not always being open at its advertised times, and has asked Thamesmead Times to help.

He says the Bureau is looking for people with a flair for helping others, who are prepared to give two days a week to be trained as volunteer advice workers.

So if you think you could help with this rewarding work, please contact him at 97, Binsey Walk or phone him on 310-3218.

A message from the Chairman



Clive Thornton, CBE, LLB.

Let's work together to build for the future, says Clive

Welcoming the publication of Thamesmead Town's new free newspaper, Chairman Clive Thornton appealed to the people of the Town to work closely together to create "a community with a soul and a heart, and in which no-one will ever feel neglected or left out."

Mr Thornton, who is soon to take up residence in Thamesmead — honouring the pledge he made at public meetings before the creation of the Thamesmead Trust — talked enthusiastically about the advantages of the town having its own newspaper.

"There has always been a problem of communication in Thamesmead — which is rather silly when you consider what a clearly identifiable community we are," he said.

He added: "There is so much enthusiasm and so much vigour and goodwill in the Town. Groups and individuals are devoting a great deal of their lives to making this a wonderful place to live.

"What we have lacked is a place where all points of view can be expressed, where all the good things — and the bad — can be communicated to everyone on a regular basis," he added.

Mr Thornton, who has been involved in newspapers at a national level, declared: "My hope is that Thamesmead Times will be honest, unbiased, and open in all its dealings with the community and that it will give everyone a chance to put their views across."

CAROLS FOR COMMUTERS

CAROL singers from Thamesmead churches will be singing at Abbey Wood Station from 5.30-7 pm on Monday, December 21st and on Wednesday, December 23rd, raising money for SHELTER.

EMERGENCIES during CHRISTMAS & NEW YEAR PERIOD

★ *Thamesmead Town's Information Centre will be closed from Christmas Eve, December 24th to 4th January 1988*

ONLY EMERGENCIES WILL BE DEALT WITH DURING THIS PERIOD

★ **PHONE 310 3369** ★

(24 hour service)